TNA teardown v2: everything wrong with the current draft and what to do by Thu 22 Oct 16:00

Wed 21 Oct 2026, ~21:00 Sydney. This replaces v1. It is based on the live "IPS Report" Doc, tab "Trading Note Reflection", top table, as last edited 21 Oct 16:08 Sydney. Each item says what is wrong and what a fix must achieve. Evidence files are in `research/assistant_review_2026-10/oct21_tna/`: the panel, factcheck, substance, research, research2, verify_teardown and week4 files.

Verdict

The draft describes the plan but never shows a decision being **tested or changed**, and that is what the TNA is marked on ("supported, tested, or refined"). The mock panel scores the reflections 5.2-5.4/10 each and the set 5.8; contention starts around 7.5. It contains:

- 3 false finance statements;
- 3 statements that contradict the team's own filed notes;
- liquidity never mentioned, although Wharton names it in the TNA's purpose;
- the case's reason for the minimum (credibility) never used;
- the strongest evidence the team has (IBTR's pre-set test, and the move from about 75% stocks to under 10%) unused.

Keep the three picks: IBTM, VT and IBTR.

Ranked fixes

#	Note	What is wrong	What the fix must achieve	Min
1	VT	"about 7.5% a year per JPMorgan" is false. JPMorgan 2026: world stocks 7.00%; 7.5% is non-US developed (EAFE). The IPS says 7%. Also, the upper bound depends on VT's **value** in 2031, not on its expected return.	Match the IPS (7%) or use no forecast. Tie VT to the range through its 2031 value.	2
2	IBTM	"clear yield" and "matures on a set date" are false. iShares shows three different yields, and the fund closes "on or about" 15 Dec with a payout that is not predictable. Both contradict the filed note ("the final payout is not fixed").	Remove both. State the real property: it holds 2032 Treasuries and pays out around Dec 2032, so the timing fits, and the payout is not fixed.	3
3	IBTR	"2036 Treasuries that mature in December 2036" is false. The bonds mature during 2036 (average around May); only the fund closes mid-December. "Held to maturity" is bond wording.	Say the fund holds 2036 Treasuries and closes around mid-December, before the 1 Jan 2037 payment.	3
4	IBTM	"a stock crash will not make her promise fail" is an absolute the case warns against: overpromising "could damage her credibility" (case lines 114-116).	Express the protection the way the IPS does: the minimum is quoted rounded down from a Treasury holding she already owns. Use the case's credibility idea, not "promise".	5
5	IBTR	The note set a test in advance and the reflection never reports it. This is the single biggest gain available. Facts on the note's own basis (cost of the ladder against $300,000): 6 Oct about $292k; 19 Oct $297,162; **20 Oct $298,216, room $1,784**. The line is not crossed, but about three-quarters of the margin is used. Trap: the 20- and 30-year yields have already fallen 0.21-0.22 points, so a literal "yields fell 0.2" reading is crossed. The team's rule is to quote no dollar level.	Report the observed result with a date. Make clear the test is the ladder's cost against $300,000, not a raw yield. Say the team held and why (the rule already routes the shortfall to the 2028 deposit, so the minimum, not the payments, absorbs it). No dollar level. **Re-check on the 21 Oct close Thursday morning**: there is a 10-14% chance it crosses. If it does, say so.	15
6	IBTR	"We bought the ladder from 2042 backwards" does not match WInS. It is true of the first round of orders on 6 Oct, but IBTR's order was cancelled and re-placed after IBTM. Bonds filled at end-of-day prices and VT on 8 Oct. Wharton checks trades. Also, "most sensitive to rates" is true but is not what decided the order: the order puts any shortfall on near payments the 2028 deposit can still fund (IPS V5).	Describe the order honestly, or drop it. If kept, give the IPS's actual reason.	5

#	Note	What is wrong	What the fix must achieve	Min
7	IBTM	"therefore became the best alternative" credits the 6 Oct email with choosing IBTM. IBTM was already the WInS stand-in on 29 Sep. The email changed **Laura's real plan** (no zero-coupon STRIPS). The rule that changed (floor quoted rounded down because a fund's payout is not fixed) is missing. IBTM also never shows that the ladder is completed first, before the floor.	Make the refinement true: what the email changed, when, and the IPS rule it produced. Keep the order: ladder first, then floor.	10
8	VT	It gives Laura's retained half jobs the VT note says stocks do not do ("only set how far her gift rises"): covering payment shortfalls. "Stays Laura's" can read as money outside the portfolio.	Keep VT's role consistent with its note and the IPS. If the half is a backstop, say it stays inside the portfolio. Do not settle the 27 Oct vote in the TNA.	10
9	VT	"9% of the portfolio" is the WInS share; in Laura's real plan stocks are about 7%. It names no alternative and no specific downside.	Say which portfolio the 9% belongs to. Name one real alternative the team rejected and VT's specific downside for Laura (it can lower only the part above the minimum).	5
10	set	Unused material: the team's biggest refinement (from about 75% stocks to under 10% after modelling showed payment shortfalls); the 2028 top-up and the minimum come from the same deposit; the 2028 deposit depends on Laura's income; liquidity (maturities, not sales, fund each payment).	Fit in at least two: liquidity once (cheap), plus the 75%-to-under-10% refinement (VT is the natural place).	15
11	set	The order reads minimum, growth, payments, which scrambles the IPS's "payments, then floor, then growth". About 25-30 words only repeat the notes.	Consider the order IBTR (payments) → IBTM (floor) → VT (growth). Cut restated note content to make room.	5
12	all	Word counts: VT and IBTR are at 99, IBTM at 94-95. A cruder counter gives VT 104 and IBTR 101. Items 5 and 7-10 add words.	Cut to make room before adding. Finish at 95 or under each, counted by spaces.	10
13	all	One working copy of the VT note reads "co-sponsors here"; WInS reads "hear". The three notes in the top table match WInS exactly.	Paste each note from WInS (or the WInS export table), never from the working section.	2

If time is short: do 1, 2, 3, 4 and 13 first (about 15 minutes). They remove every false or contradictory line. Then do 5 and 7, which are the main score gains.

What the evidence says wins

These points come from all 45 Wharton competition articles (2019-2026), past reports, and CFA, FINRA, ASIC, ESMA and FCA practice.

- **Judges praise:**
  - the client's goals linked to the strategy;
  - "depth and accuracy" and quality control;
  - "simple, elegant ideas";
  - discipline plus willingness to adapt ("capacity to adapt and pivot");
  - forward-looking reasons, not past returns.
- **Professional trade-rationale tests:**
  - name the specific client fact;
  - state the specific downside;
  - keep facts separate from forecasts;
  - record a review even when nothing was traded (IBTR is exactly this).
- **Past notes are a low bar:** a 2024 Global Finalist's notes quoted no note and claimed "almost certain to grow".
- **No TNA rubric is published:** it is read with the IPS and Final Report against the five criteria, for "a clear and consistent investment strategy across all three".

Also for Thursday

- **Open the IPS form during the TNA session.** The Week 4 email says the IPS is now a form, but the public instructions still say "Submit as a PDF … 5 MB". Ask Wharton which applies.

- **Final Report instructions:** Mon 9 Nov 09:00 ET = **Tue 10 Nov 01:00 Sydney**.
- **IPS V5 changed on 21 Oct.** The pending suggestions now show as accepted.
  - The "her other holdings" wording reads as outside money, against the case.
  - Several numbers are stale against the latest model: "$21,000 short", "$136,000" floor, "$169,000 to $162,000".
  - Fix these before the IPS goes in, and make sure the TNA does not repeat any of them.